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California bans red dye 3 and other harmful chemicals from Skittles

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California has become the first U.S. state to ban the use of four potentially harmful additives, including red dye 3, for foods and beverages that have been linked to a variety of diseases, including cancer, and are already banned in dozens of countries.

California banned Skittles What does red dye 3 or potassium bromide produce? California Food Safety Law What changes will there be in California? Supporters of the law say it doesn't mean that popular products will suddenly disappear from store shelves, but that companies will have to modify their recipes to be able to offer the same foods and beverages with healthier ingredients. "Californians will still be able to access and enjoy their favorite food products, with greater confidence in the safety of those products," explained Governor Gavin Newsom, who signed the bill into law last Saturday. The proposal has been the subject of a false claim that California is trying to ban Skittles. In fact, Assemblyman Jesse Gabriel, a Democrat who sponsored the bill, has said Skittles are sold with alternative ingredients in the European Union, where all four additives are already banned. The Food and Drug Administration banned the use of red dye 3 in cosmetics in 1990 after evidence showed it caused cancer in laboratory animals. But the government has not banned its use in food and it is an ingredient in corn-based candies. Brominated vegetable oil and potassium bromide have also been associated with harmful effects on the respiratory and nervous systems, while propylparaben can adversely affect reproductive health. The California Food Safety Act bans the manufacture, distribution and sale of foods and beverages containing brominated vegetable oil, potassium bromate, propylparaben and red dye 3, which can be found in candy, fruit juices, cookies and more. The law will not be implemented until 2027, which Newsom says will give companies ample time to "revise their recipes to avoid these harmful chemicals" in their products.

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